

NATURAL GAS ANALYST

US-Iran Agreement Paves Way For European Storage Refill

- We maintain our 2H26/2027 TTF price forecasts largely unchanged at 41/30 EUR/MWh (vs 42/30 EUR/MWh prev., forwards at 42/35) following the announced US-Iran agreement to restore energy flows through the Strait of Hormuz. Although we assume LNG flows will normalize by end-Jul, later than our previous end-Jun expectation, higher ex-Qatar supply and a lower market target for European storage offset the tightening effect from a later reopening.
- First, global LNG supply ex-Qatar has risen more than we expected, partly driven by maintenance avoidance. Second, TTF pricing in recent weeks suggests that the market is targeting a 70%-75% gas storage fill this summer, lower than the 80% we had previously assumed, as LNG supply growth improves winter gas availability. We estimate NW European storage can reach a 74% fill as long as gas prices remain expensive relative to coal, in the low 40 EURs/MWh.
- In 2027, we expect that the combination of a higher end-winter (Mar27) storage vs this year and continued growth in global LNG supply will take NW Europe end-Oct27 storage to a very comfortable 89% full, allowing gas to balance the market while pricing below 35 EUR/MWh coal. Accordingly, we maintain our average 2027 TTF price forecast at 30 EUR/MWh.
- Risks to our 2026/27 gas price view remain skewed to the upside. Should the blocking of Hormuz largely continue, allowing for an only gradual normalization of flows through 2027, we estimate TTF would likely need to move above 100 EUR/MWh this winter (and average above 50 EUR in 2027) to discourage Asia LNG demand. In contrast, even if we see a faster-than-expected ramp of Hormuz flows and start-up of the upcoming Qatari LNG expansion, we estimate only a modest softening of European gas balances likely pressuring 2027 TTF to 27 EUR/MWh.
- Longer term, we maintain our bearish 2028/29 TTF view at 19/16 EUR/MWh (vs forwards at 27/24), with risks skewed to the downside. Recent FIDs of new US LNG export projects signal a larger and longer-lasting LNG oversupply vs what we already embed in our balances. Further, a potential pick up in coal and renewable generation in the aftermath of the Iran conflict might reduce Asia's appetite for natural gas demand in the coming years vs our base case.

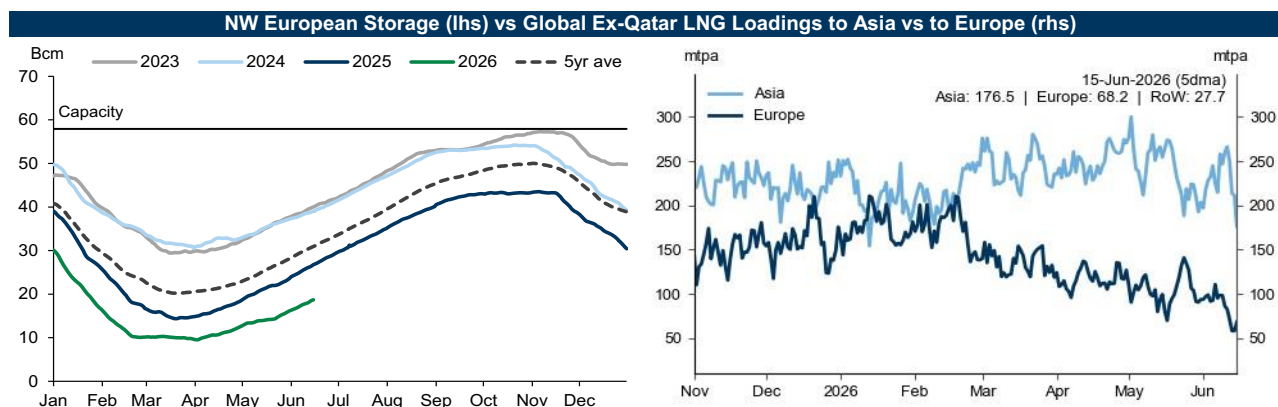
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US-Iran Agreement Paves Way For European Storage Refill

We had been emphasizing in recent client conversations that European gas markets had been at a crossroads. The loss of Qatari LNG supply was never sustainable for European gas markets owing to the need for gas storage to refill ahead of the winter, especially given the strong rebound in Asia LNG demand since May ([Exhibit 1](#)). So, either LNG flows through the Strait of Hormuz would start to normalize to allow European gas storage to refill, or TTF would have to rally to get it done by discouraging Asia LNG demand.

Exhibit 1: Low European gas storage and an ongoing Asia pull for LNG cargoes at the expense of Europe would likely lead to a further rise in TTF without a Hormuz flow normalization

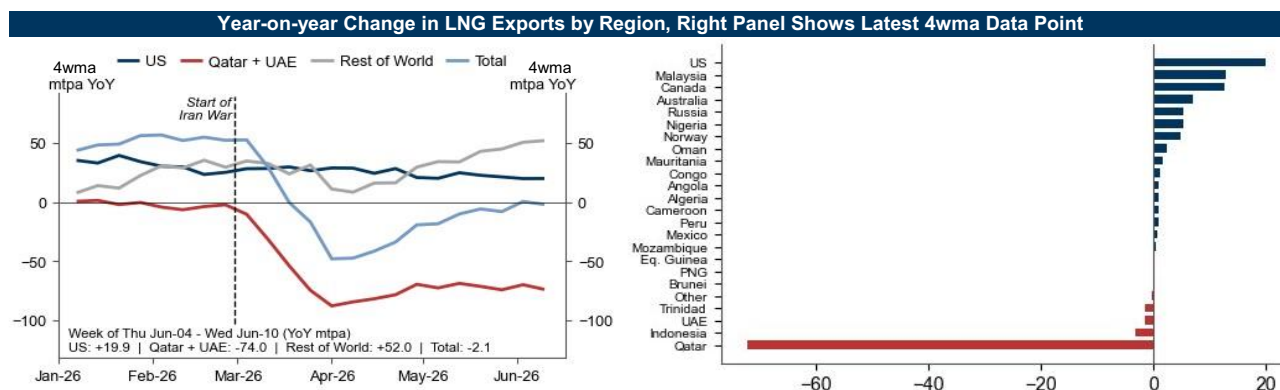


Source: Bloomberg, Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The recently announced agreement between the US and Iran potentially allows for the former, leading us to keep our 2H26 TTF forecast largely unchanged at 41 EUR/MW (vs 42 EUR/MWh previously, and forwards at 42 EUR/MWh).

Specifically, we now assume LNG flows through the Strait of Hormuz normalize (short of the 13 mtpa long-term damage to Qatari export capacity) by end-Jul, a month later than our previous end-Jun expectation. However, higher ex-Qatar supply and a lower market target for European storage offset the tightening effect from a later reopening.

First, global LNG supply ex-Qatar has risen more than we expected, primarily driven by a combination of apparent maintenance avoidance in places like Oman, Malaysia and Norway, a sharp rebound in feedgas in Nigeria and higher sanctioned LNG supply exports from Russia ([Exhibit 2](#)). On net, we raise our Jun26 global ex-Qatar LNG supply forecast by 10 mtpa vs our pre-war expectations to 384 mtpa.

Exhibit 2: Supply growth ex-Qatar has taken global LNG supply back to flat yoy

Source: Kpler, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

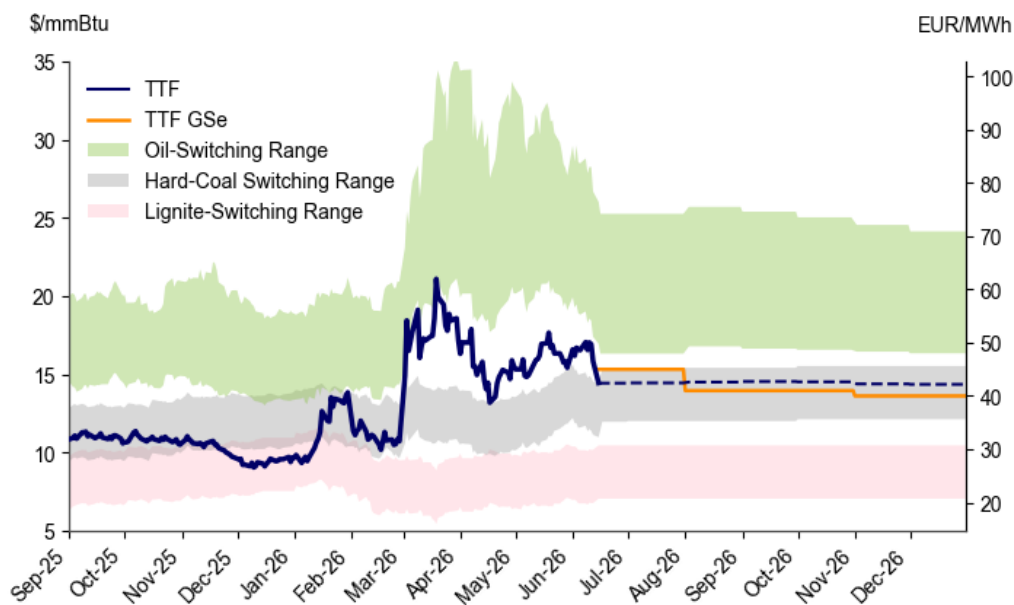
Second, TTF pricing in recent weeks suggests that the market has not been pushing to take storage to 80% full, as we had previously assumed, and appears comfortable taking storage to a lower 70%-75% fill range. We believe this has been driven by growing global LNG supply, which effectively eases gas storage management through winter. Specifically, we estimate that a 70%-75% storage fill ahead of this winter would still allow for an end-winter storage level (assuming 10-year average temperatures) near 30% full, which is high enough to withstand a one-standard deviation colder than average winter, worth 12% of storage capacity in North West Europe.

We estimate NW European storage can reach 74% full by end-Oct26 as long as European gas prices remain expensive relative to coal, in the low 40 EURs/MWh, for the remainder of summer. To be clear, we estimate gas-to-coal switching is maximized when TTF is at least 5 EUR /MWh above coal generation costs. And although coal summer forwards are currently near 40 EUR/MWh, implying forward gas might have to reach 45 EUR to incentivize max fuel switching, we expect coal prices to realize lower as forward risk premium comes off. Prompt coal generation costs have already started to drop, currently at approximately 37 EUR/MWh in gas equivalent terms, which we expect will drop a bit further in the coming months.

Accordingly, we keep our 3Q26/4Q26 TTF price forecasts largely unchanged at 42/40 EUR/MWh (44/40 EUR/MWh prev.) ([Exhibit 3](#)). We raise our expected JKM premium to TTF to \$2/mmBtu (from \$1) in peak summer (Jul-Aug) to reflect the strengthening in Asia pull for LNG cargoes we've observed in recent weeks, leaving our 3Q26/4Q26 JKM price forecast at \$16.10/\$14.75/mmBtu (vs \$15.90/\$14.65 prev.).

Exhibit 3: We expect European gas prices to balance the market in the low 40 EURs/MWh for the remainder of summer

Realized and forward TTF prices and fuel switching ranges, and TTF GS fcast



^ Forwards as of 15-Jun-2026

Prices shown in gas-equivalent terms and inclusive of carbon.

Source: ICE, S&P Global Commodity Insights, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Should Hormuz Flows Normalize In Coming Weeks, 2027 Looks Comfortably Supplied...

Going into 2027 we expect that the combination of a higher end-winter (March) storage level vs this year and continued growth in global LNG supply, which we expect up 47 mtpa yoy to 488 mtpa, will take NW Europe end-Oct27 storage to 89% full, a more than comfortable level ahead of the 2027-28 winter. This balance is consistent with TTF prices moving gradually below hard coal levels in the mid-30 EURs/MWh to incentivize higher European gas demand and, in turn, keep gas storage away from congestion. Accordingly, we maintain our average 2027 TTF price forecast at 30 EUR/MWh (below forwards at 35 EUR/MWh). Our 2027 JKM forecast at \$11.10/mmBtu is a touch above our previous \$10.95 forecast owing to rounding and a minor increase in the JKM premium to TTF assumed for the winter.

Exhibit 4: We maintain our TTF forecasts largely unchanged, as we expect a normalization of Hormuz flows to allow European storage to refill at current price levels
TTF and JKM GS forecasts vs forwards

	GS TTF fcast. (EUR/MWh)	Previous	TTF fwrds. (EUR/MWh)	GS TTF fcast. TTF (\$/mmBtu)	Previous	GS JKM fcast. (\$/mmBtu)	Previous	JKM fwrds (\$/mmBtu)
3Q26	42	44	43	14.40	14.90	16.10	15.90	16.55
4Q26	40	40	42	13.75	13.65	14.75	14.65	15.30
1Q27	38	38	41	12.95	12.95	13.80	13.70	14.40
2Q27	31	30	33	10.55	10.25	11.30	11.00	11.80
3Q27	27	27	32	9.20	9.20	9.95	9.95	11.85
4Q27	25	25	32	8.50	8.50	9.25	9.25	11.95
Bal 2026	41	42	42	14.10	14.25	15.40	15.25	15.90
2027	30	30	35	10.30	10.20	11.10	10.95	12.50
2028	19	19	27	6.50	6.50	6.90	6.90	10.10
2029	16	16	24	5.50	5.50	5.70	5.70	8.95
2030	20	20	22	6.75	6.75	7.00	7.00	8.35
2031	21	21	22	7.15	7.15	7.45	7.45	8.50
2032	21	21	22	7.15	7.15	7.60	7.60	8.75
2033	32	32	23	10.90	10.90	11.50	11.50	9.05
2034	42	42	23	14.30	14.30	15.40	15.40	9.30
2035	42	42	24	14.30	14.30	15.50	15.50	9.60

Forwards as of June 15th, 2026.

Source: ICE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

...Though Hormuz Uncertainty Keeps Risks to 2026/27 TTF Skewed to the Upside

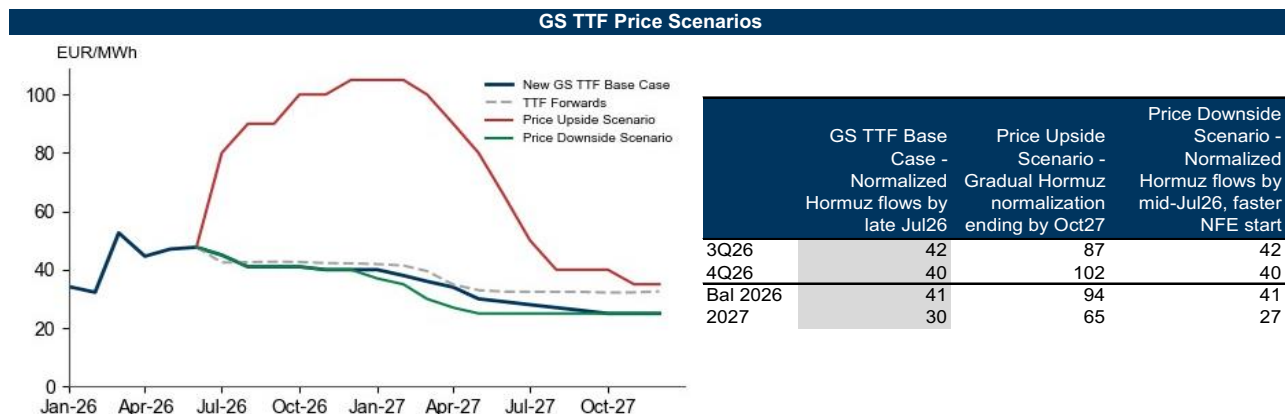
Should the blocking of Hormuz largely continue, if for example the current agreement falls through, allowing for an only gradual normalization of flows through 2027¹, we estimate European storage would likely face significant potential tightness this winter. As a result, we estimate TTF would likely need to move above 100 EUR/MWh this winter (and average above 50 EUR in 2027) to discourage Asia LNG demand.

In contrast, even if we see a faster-than-expected ramp of Hormuz flows (4wks vs 6wks base case) and start-up of the upcoming Qatari LNG export expansion (2Q27 vs our now pushed back base case of 3Q27), we estimate little change to European gas balances beyond taking end-Oct27 storage just above 90% full. Under such a scenario, we would expect 2H26 TTF prices unchanged vs our base case and 2027 average prices only modestly lower, at 27 EUR/MWh, to incentivize incremental gas demand to manage European storage away from congestion.

¹ LNG flows through Hormuz have increased only very gradually since the start of the war and remain well below normal.

Exhibit 5: Risks to our 2026/27 TTF view remain skewed to the upside

EUR/MWh



NFE is the first expansion train currently under construction in Qatar. We assume it comes online in 3Q27 under our baseline and in 2Q27 in our price downside scenario.

Source: ICE, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Longer-term TTF and JKM Risks Remain Skewed to The Downside

We maintain our bearish long-term TTF view, with a 19/16 EUR/MWh forecast for 2028/2029 vs forwards at 27/24 EUR/MWh, and continue to see risks to our view skewed to the downside. Recent FIDs of new US LNG export projects like Commonwealth LNG (9.5 mtpa, 2030 planned start) and phase 1 of Delfin LNG (4.4 mtpa, 2030 planned start) signal a larger and longer-lasting global LNG oversupply vs what we already embed in our balances. Further, a potential pick up in coal and renewable generation in the aftermath of the Iran conflict might reduce Asia's appetite for natural gas demand in the coming years vs our base case.

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